

SIGNATURE TALENT	Eleanor Marsh, Mutual Founder EXECUTIVE  HIRE ◆ 5 SIGNATURE Signature: one copy per deck. Requires a Life funding source. Each Mortality clause costs you 1 less Surplus. Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Mortality clauses. <i>Started the company in 1952 with a card table and a mortality table, and still uses both.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 203 / 386	Des Moines OFFICE LOCATION  OPEN ◆ 3 <i>branch only</i> Headquarters or Open as a branch. At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down. At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies). <i>Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 363 / 386	Whole Life LIFE  CAPACITY ◆ 1 <i>Leverage a turn</i> MARGIN ● 1 <i>run start</i> STAPLE ▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation <i>Staple: any number per deck.</i> If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing. <i>Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 386
	Whole Life LIFE  CAPACITY ◆ 1 <i>Leverage a turn</i> MARGIN ● 1 <i>run start</i> STAPLE ▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation <i>Staple: any number per deck.</i> If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing. <i>Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 386	Whole Life LIFE  CAPACITY ◆ 1 <i>Leverage a turn</i> MARGIN ● 1 <i>run start</i> STAPLE ▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation <i>Staple: any number per deck.</i> If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing. <i>Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 386	Whole Life LIFE  CAPACITY ◆ 1 <i>Leverage a turn</i> MARGIN ● 1 <i>run start</i> STAPLE ▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation <i>Staple: any number per deck.</i> If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing. <i>Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.</i> ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 386
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FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Mortality

▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality

▲ Regulation

▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality

▲ Regulation

▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality

▲ Regulation

▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Indexed Universal Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Mortality

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A life product wearing an equity-market jacket.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 005 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▲ Health Price

▲ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▲ Health Price

▲ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 386

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Short-Term Equity

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Rising Interest Rates exposure.

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 053 / 386

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Short-Term Equity

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Rising Interest Rates exposure.

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 053 / 386

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Affiliate Loan

ILLIQUID

DARK

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 2

each turn

DARK

SIGNATURE

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Destroyed if Whistleblower or Market Conduct Exam hits you.

The float was invested conservatively, in companies owned by the insurer's owner.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 088 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

Mortality Retrocession

TREATY

COST

◆ 2

Requires a Life funding source.

Halve your loss from Mortality clauses (round down).

Someone else can worry about the tail of the mortality curve.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 117 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

Mortality Retrocession

TREATY

COST

◆ 2

Requires a Life funding source.

Halve your loss from Mortality clauses (round down).

Someone else can worry about the tail of the mortality curve.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 117 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Cat Bond Sponsorship: Mortality

TREATY

COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Life or Health funding source.

When Mortality clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Capital-markets investors take the pandemic tail, for a price.

L

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 126 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Side Letter

TREATY

DARK

COST

◆ 3

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

DARK

SIGNATURE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Risk transfer on the cover page, and a letter in the drawer saying the reinsurer gets it all back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 145 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY

COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 115 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 115 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Too Big to Fail

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus. If all remaining players become insolvent because of this, you win the game.

What regulators call interconnectedness, your rivals call a hostage situation.

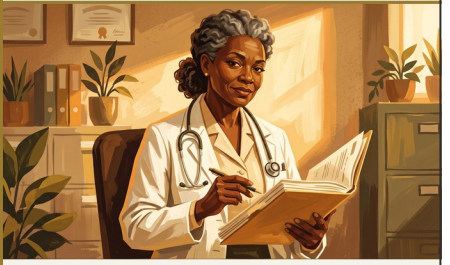
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 142 / 386

TALENT

Medical Director

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 5

Requires a Life funding source.

Your Life funding sources have +1 Margin.

Knows which applicants are fine and which are 'fine.'

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 179 / 386

TALENT

Business School Dean

ACADEMIC



HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for an employee, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Knows every alum worth hiring, and which ones owe the annual fund.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 216 / 386

TALENT

Mortality Researcher

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Life funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Mortality clauses.

Spots the trend in the claims data a quarter before anyone else does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 181 / 386

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Rated Feeder Note

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

SIGNATURE

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Basel III Endgame or Solvency II hits you.

The same private loans, sliced so the capital charge drops from thirty percent to four.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 087 / 386

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

▼ Rising Interest Rates

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Dash for Cash, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Great Depression hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 073 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 360 / 386

TOOL

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Scenario Rehearsal

ACTION - YOUR TURN



COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

On your turn, privately look at the next 2 shared pile cards. Return them in either order, then discard this. Developing and delayed Stress Tests still happen first.

The disasters are still coming. The order is negotiable.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Hurricane Katrina

NAT CAT - AS-IF REPLAY, 2005



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Flood ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

In August 2005, Hurricane Katrina struck the Gulf Coast, and failed levees left about 80 percent of New Orleans under water.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 241 / 386

1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT - AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

Surprise trust fall.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 258 / 386

mRNA Breakthrough

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

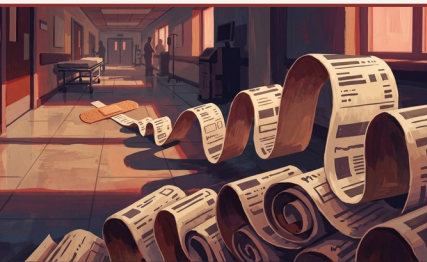
A platform built for one virus turns out to work on a lot of things.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 252 / 386

The \$1,000 Pill

HEALTH · AS-IF REPLAY, 2014



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Health Price exposure.

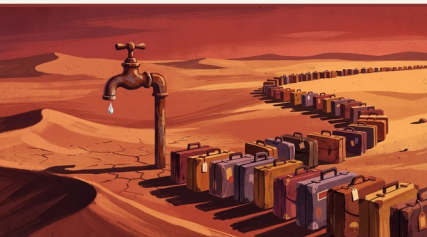
In 2014, Sovaldi, a new cure for hepatitis C, cost \$1,000 a pill, \$84,000 for a course, and health plans' drug bills jumped. Bandages now come with a payment plan.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 254 / 386

Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 386

Great Depression

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 1929



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Credit exposure, and 2 per investment it controls.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In October 1929, the U.S. stock market crashed, and by 1933 about a quarter of American workers had no job.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 279 / 386

Roundup Verdict

LITIGATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2018



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

In August 2018, a San Francisco jury ordered Monsanto to pay \$289 million to a groundskeeper who blamed its weedkiller, Roundup, for his cancer.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 289 / 386

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity
▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 274 / 386

1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Rising Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 386

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 308 / 386

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 293 / 386

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 386

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 386

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 346 / 386

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 386

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

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